

Quick and Easy Pho

Ingredients

- ☐ 8 oz [dried rice vermicelli noodles](#)
- ☐ Desired meat: chicken, pork, steak or raw shrimp*, (See notes)
- ☐ 1 large yellow onion, quartered
- ☐ 2 (2-inch pieces) fresh ginger, , unpeeled and halved, length-wise
- ☐ 6 cups broth , (chicken, beef or vegetable, depending on protein choice)
- ☐ 2 cups water
- ☐ 1/4 tsp [ground coriander](#)
- ☐ 1 [whole clove](#) , (optional)
- ☐ 1 1/2 Tablespoons [fish sauce](#), (or less, to taste preference)
- ☐ ¼ teaspoon [hoisin sauce](#)
- ☐ 1/4 teaspoon soy sauce
- ☐ ¼ teaspoon [red chili paste](#) , (sambal oelek)
- ☐ 1 stick cinnamon
- ☐ [salt and freshly ground black pepper](#)

For garnish (this is where pho soup shines!):

- ☐ 4 green onions, , chopped
- ☐ 2 fresh jalapeño peppers or red thai chili peppers, , thinly sliced and seeds removed
- ☐ 1 bunch fresh cilantro, , chopped
- ☐ 1 bunch Thai basil leaves
- ☐ 1 cup fresh bean sprouts
- ☐ 2 limes, , cut into wedges
- ☐ [Sriracha hot sauce, or additional red chili paste](#), , for heat, optional

Directions

1. Place a large dry pot over medium heat add the onion halves and ginger pieces. Cook for 4 minutes, stirring occasionally.
2. Add the broth, water, coriander, clove, fish sauce, hoisin sauce, soy sauce, chili garlic paste, cinnamon stick and a pinch of fresh cracked salt and pepper to the pot. Bring to a slow boil, then reduce heat and simmer for 30 minutes.

3. Meanwhile, prepare noodles according to package instructions. Once soft, drain, rinse and set aside.
4. Ready the garnishes in individual small bowls for serving: cilantro, basil, green onions, bean sprouts, lime wedges and sliced chilies.
5. 1-5 minutes before the broth is done cooking, add desired meat to the broth to cook, just until done (2-3 minutes for raw, thinly sliced chicken or pork, 1-2 minutes for shrimp or thinly sliced steak).
6. Discard the ginger, clove, cinnamon stick and onion pieces from the pot.
7. Divide the noodles among bowls; ladle broth on top (and meat). Add desired toppings

Notes

Protein: It's important to slice the meat as thinly as possible, against the grain.

- **Beef Pho (*phở bò*):** ½ pound sirloin steak, flank steak or brisket, sliced very thinly and seasoned with salt and pepper.
- **Chicken Pho (*phở gà*):** Slice 1-2 boneless, skinless breasts into very thin pieces, against the grain. Season with salt and pepper.
- **Pork Pho:** Season a 1 lb pork tenderloin with salt and pepper and sear in a little bit of oil in a very hot pan until browned on all sides (about 10 minute). Allow to rest while broth cooks and then slice into very thin slices.

Mic's Notes

I would advise putting in at *least* 3 whole cloves, it really helps bring this closer to a Pho flavor. I also use the white portion of the green onions in the broth to add a little more sweetness.